

4Prep — Hiring Plan

Three roles to build the platform and the data behind it · Prepared 10 August 2026 · 90-day plan

1. University Data Researcher

Freelance · paid per accepted record · start now

The job	Source the 17 admissions records we hold per university — tuition, fees, room and board, aid for international students, English requirements, deadlines, F-1 financial certification — from official university pages only. Every figure needs a link, the date it was checked, and a saved PDF.
Why first	The catalogue is 10 universities. A student exhausts it in one session. This is the cheapest way to make the product worth returning to, and it deepens the one thing competitors cannot copy quickly.
Must have	Meticulous. Reads English university websites accurately. Knows the difference between “minimum IELTS 7 required” and “our strongest applicants usually have IELTS 7”. Comfortable writing “not published” as a finished answer instead of quietly guessing.
Deliverables	30 days 8–10 new universities fully sourced · 60 days 25–30 total, 10% spot-audit passing · 90 days 40–50 total, covering what students actually search for.
Screening question	“A university lists tuition, fees, room and board separately but publishes no total. Do you add them up?” The right answer is no, never.
Paid trial	Source one university we do not have — Berry College — for all 17 items. Grade on: zero invented values, links to exact pages not homepages, and gaps written as finished answers. (~\$30–50)
Budget	\$900–1,400 over 90 days, paid per accepted record rather than per hour.

2. Data Scientist

Part-time ~10 h/week · start at ~25 universities

The job	Own the quality and structure of the catalogue as it grows: validate incoming records against their sources, catch contradictions and duplicates, normalise costs and currencies so universities compare fairly, and build the checks that stop a bad figure reaching a student. Later, analyse what students search for and where the catalogue falls short.
Boundary	They work on the fit-score engine, not as its author. The scoring method, its weights, and the data-acceptance standard stay yours — that is the original contribution the product exists to demonstrate, and it should not move to a hire.
Must have	Python and SQL. Comfortable in Postgres. Careful with messy real-world data. Will flag a suspicious number rather than smooth it over. Statistics background helps but judgement matters more.
Deliverables	30 days automated validation on every incoming record · 60 days currency and cost normalisation the fit score can trust · 90 days a written report on catalogue gaps versus real student demand.
Screening question	“Two official pages from the same university give different tuition figures. What do you do?” Listening for: keep both, mark it unresolved, escalate — not average them.
Timing note	At 10 universities there is little for this role to do. Their value grows with the catalogue, so start them after the researcher has built it up. Hiring both on day one wastes the more expensive one.
Budget	\$3,000–4,500 over 90 days at roughly 10 hours a week.

3. Full-Stack Developer

Part-time 10–15 h/week · monthly renewable · start now

The job	Take the platform work off your desk so your hours go to method, data standards and students. First: get the app live at app.4prep.ai with backups, email and error alerts working. Then: speed on slow phone connections, and the data-quality guard that stops unverified records reaching the public catalogue before the researcher starts importing.
Do not brief them on	The admin console, support chat, learning portal, accounts, or the dashboard. All are built and working. Read the code before writing the job description — the plan is ahead of itself here.
Must have	TypeScript and React. Supabase or Postgres, including row-level security. Can deploy and configure DNS and email without hand-holding. Works from written briefs across a time difference.
Screening question	“Our app shows a university’s tuition. The official page does not publish it. What does the screen show?” If the answer is “N/A”, “0”, a dash, or “estimate from similar schools” — end the interview. This one question filters more candidates than the rest of the process combined.
Deliverables	30 days live at app.4prep.ai, backups on, one restore tested · 60 days fast on a mid-range Android phone; unverified records blocked at the database · 90 days a written handover document.
Budget	\$2,700–3,750 over 90 days at 10 hours a week; ~\$5,600 at 15 hours.

Cost and sequence

Role	Engagement	Start	90-day cost
1. University data researcher	Freelance, per accepted record	Now	\$900 – 1,400
2. Data scientist	Part-time, ~10 h/week	At ~25 universities	\$3,000 – 4,500
3. Full-stack developer	Part-time, 10–15 h/week	Now	\$2,700 – 5,600
Paid trial tasks	One-off, 3 candidates	Before offers	\$200 – 400
Running costs	Hosting, database, monitoring	Now	\$250 – 450
Total			\$7,050 – 12,350

Two notes before you hire

Costs are estimates, not quotes. They assume hiring in Tashkent, Central Asia, or remote Eastern Europe. At US rates, multiply by three to five.

One number is still missing. What one enrolled Academy student is worth has not been written down. Until it is, no budget on this page can be checked against what it returns — including this one. It is a two-hour exercise and it is worth doing before the first offer goes out.

This plan covers building the platform and the data behind it. Recruiting students and answering their requests is set aside for now, by decision.